

Arctodus

ARK-toe-duss



- **When** 2 million–10,000 years ago (Late Pleistocene)
- **Fossil location** Canada, USA, Mexico
- **Habitat** Mountains and woodlands
- **Length** 10 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Omnivorous

This huge predator was the largest bear ever known. When it reared up on its hindlimbs, it was more than twice the height of a man. *Arctodus* charged at prey such as deer, bison, and horses, outrunning them on its long legs.

It also ate plant foods and probably scavenged on carcasses, too.



Powerful jaw with a strong bite

Miacis

me-AH-kiss

- **When** 55 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** Europe, N. America
- **Habitat** Tropical forests
- **Length** 1 ft (0.3 m)
- **Diet** Small mammals, reptiles, birds

Miacis was a member of the family from which all modern carnivorous mammals evolved. A small animal about the size of a weasel, it had a similarly slender body and short legs. *Miacis* lived high up in trees, using its agile limbs to climb. Its long tail helped it balance as it leaped from branch to branch. It probably hunted smaller animals, such as small mammals and reptiles, using its sharp teeth to tear off flesh in a scissorlike action. It might also have eaten eggs and fruit. Its vision, though good, was not as sharp as that of modern dogs.

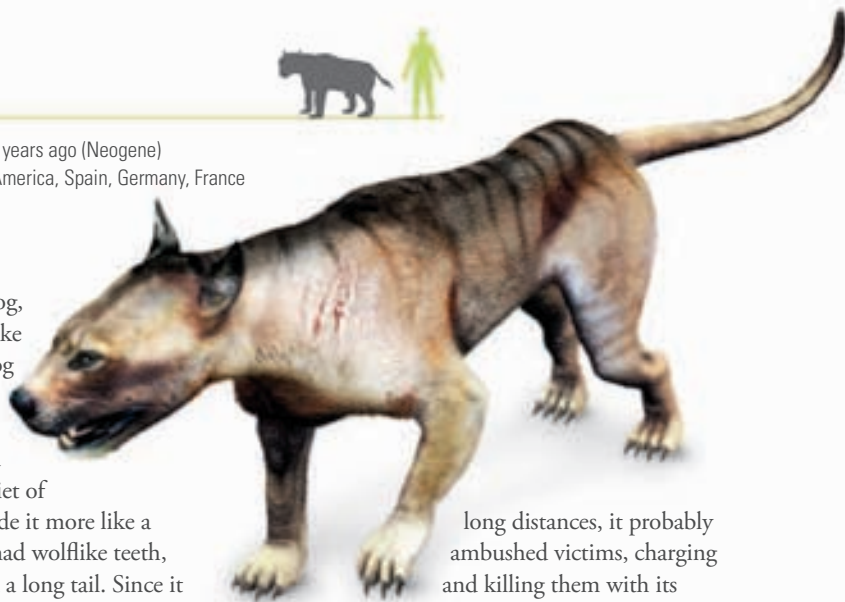
Amphicyon

am-fee-SIGH-on



- **When** 30–20 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America, Spain, Germany, France
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Length** 6½ ft (2 m)
- **Diet** Omnivorous

Also called a bear-dog, *Amphicyon* looked like a cross between a dog and a bear. But its large build—it was the size of a modern grizzly bear—and diet of plants and meat made it more like a bear than a dog. It had wolflike teeth, powerful limbs, and a long tail. Since it was too heavily built to chase prey over



long distances, it probably ambushed victims, charging and killing them with its powerful jaws and teeth.

Enaliarctos

en-AL-ee-ARK-toss

- **When** 20 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Coasts
- **Length** 3 ft (1 m)
- **Diet** Fish, meat, shellfish

Enaliarctos was one of the earliest members of the pinniped family, which includes seals, sea lions, and walruses. It seems to have divided its time between water and land, rather like a modern sea lion does. With its webbed feet and flippers, *Enaliarctos*

swam easily through water, although it was more clumsy on land. Its large eyes helped it to see in deep water, and it had specialized inner ears for hearing underwater. Its teeth were well suited to slicing through flesh, and it probably returned to the shore to eat the fish or shellfish it caught.



► SURE-FOOTED

The needle-sharp claws on *Miacis*'s toes helped it to hold onto trees as it climbed.

